

WHAT'S NEW

Week 13 · March 23–27, 2026

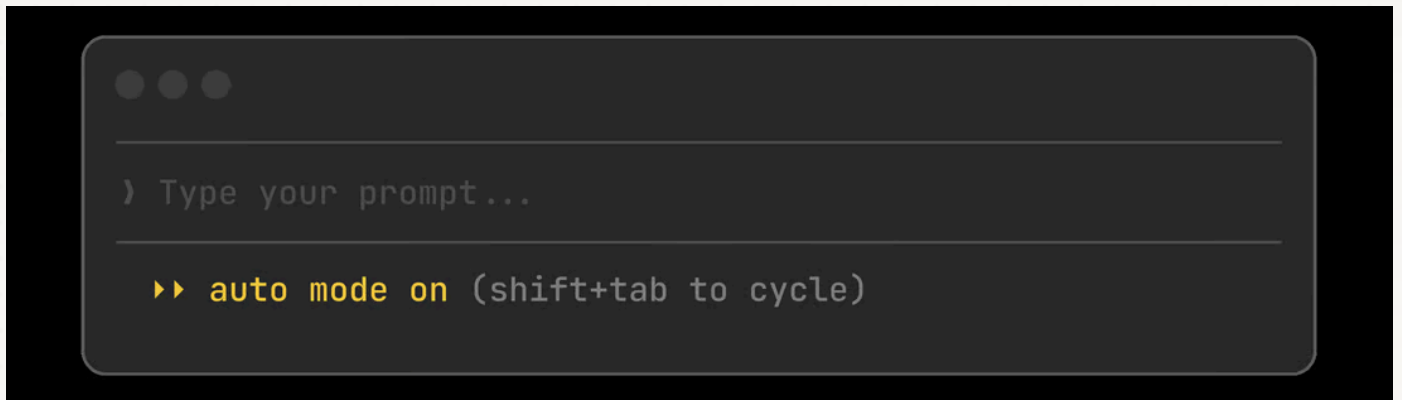
Auto mode for hands-off permissions, computer use built in, PR auto-fix in the cloud, transcript search, and a PowerShell tool for Windows.

Releases **v2.1.83** → **v2.1.85**

6 features · March 23–27

Auto mode research preview

Auto mode hands your permission prompts to a classifier. Safe edits and commands run without interrupting you; anything destructive or suspicious gets blocked and surfaced. It's the middle ground between approving every file write and running with `dangerously-skip-permissions`.



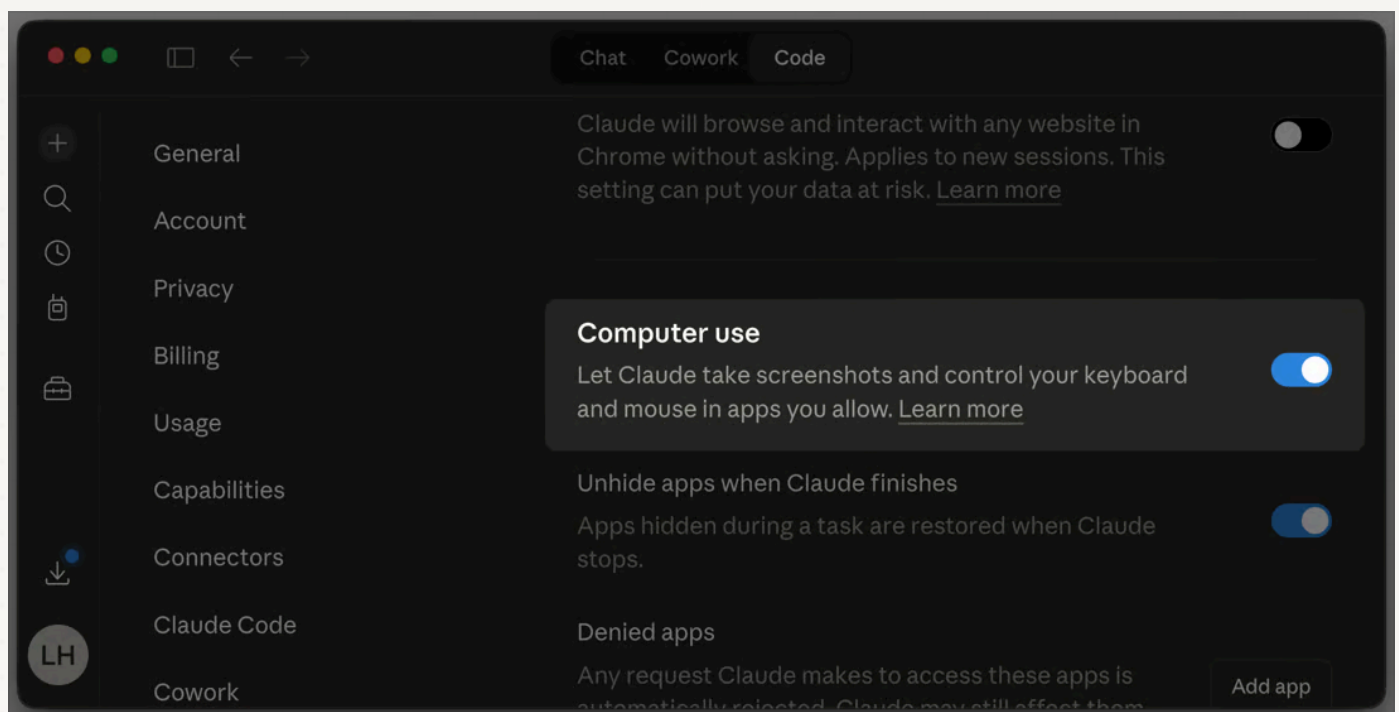
Cycle to auto with Shift+Tab, or set it as your default:

~/claude/settings.json

```
{
  "permissions": {
    "defaultMode": "auto"
  }
}
```

Computer use Desktop

Claude can now control your actual desktop from the Claude Code Desktop app: open native apps, click through the iOS simulator, drive hardware control panels, and verify changes on screen. It's off by default and asks before each action. Best for the things nothing else can reach: apps without an API, proprietary tools, anything that only exists as a GUI.

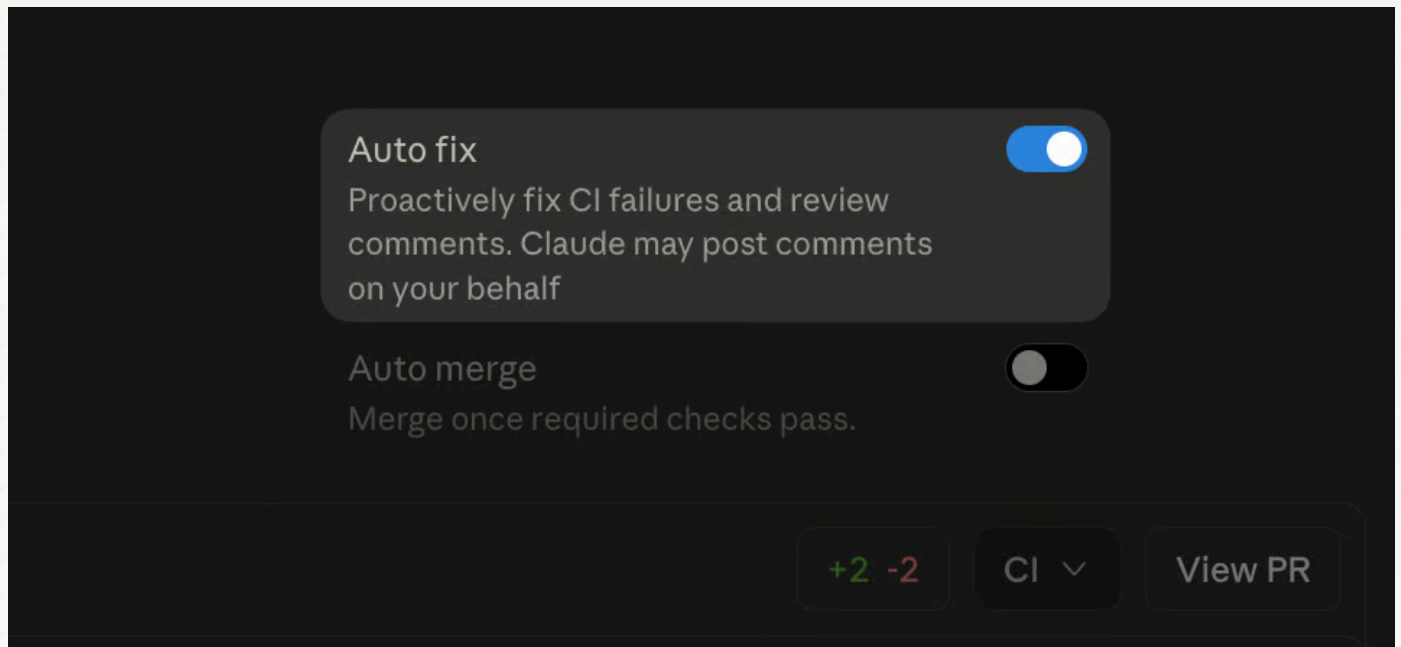


Enable it in Settings, grant the OS permissions, then ask Claude to verify a change end to end:

Claude Code

```
> Open the iOS simulator, tap through the onboarding flow, and  
screenshot each step
```

Flip a switch when you open a PR and walk away. Claude watches CI, fixes the failures, handles the nits, and pushes until it's green. No more babysitting a PR through six rounds of lint errors.



After creating a PR on Claude Code web, toggle Auto fix in the CI panel.

[Auto-fix pull requests →](#)

Transcript search v2.1.83

Press `/` in transcript mode to search your conversation. `n` and `N` step through matches. Finally a way to find that one Bash command Claude ran 400 messages ago.

Open transcript mode and search:

Claude Code

```
Ctrl+O    # open transcript
/migrate   # search for "migrate"
n          # next match
N          # previous match
```

[Fullscreen guide →](#)

PowerShell tool

preview

v2.1.84

Windows gets a native PowerShell tool alongside Bash. Claude can run cmdlets, pipe objects, and work with Windows-native paths without translating everything through Git Bash.

Opt in from settings:

.claude/settings.json

```
{
  "env": {
    "CLAUDE_CODE_USE_POWERSHELL_TOOL": "1"
  }
}
```

[PowerShell tool docs](#) →

Conditional hooks

v2.1.85

Hooks can now declare an `if` field using permission rule syntax. Your pre-commit check only spawns for `Bash(git commit *)` instead of every bash call, cutting the process overhead on busy sessions.

Scope a hook to git commits only:

.claude/settings.json

```
{
  "hooks": {
    "PreToolUse": [{
      "hooks": [{
        "if": "Bash(git commit *)",
        "type": "command",
        "command": ".claude/hooks/lint-staged.sh"
      }]
    }]
  }
}
```

[Hooks reference →](#)

Other wins

- + Plugin `userConfig` now public: prompt for settings at enable time, keychain-backed secrets
- + `managed-settings.d/` drop-in directory for layered policy fragments
- + Agents can declare `initialPrompt` in frontmatter to auto-submit a first turn
- + Interrupting before any response restores your input automatically
- + Deep links open in your preferred terminal, not first-detected
- + VS Code: rate limit banner, Esc-twice rewind picker
- + Pasted images insert `[Image #N]` chips you can reference positionally
- + `CwdChanged` and `FileChanged` hook events for direnv-style setups
- + `Ctrl+X Ctrl+E` opens your external editor, matching readline
- + `/status` now works while Claude is responding
- + Idle-return nudge to `/clear` after 75+ minutes away

[Full changelog for v2.1.83-v2.1.85 →](#)